

a feed reader or feed aggregator. Newer browsers like Opera 9 and IE7 include an RSS feed reader, as do some e-mail clients. Additionally there are Web sites that can offer similar functionality as a standalone client.

Websites that create RSS feeds have links to them on the site. If the browser supports RSS feeds, clicking on the link will launch the inbuilt client or the external feed reader.

The list of sites offering a feed can be had from many online sources, like syndic8.com. Some sites offer a list of feed links as a file. Such a list is created in OPML (Outline Processor Markup language) which is also based on XML, and all feed readers are capable of reading/opening it. Lists of feeds created by you can also be saved as an OPML file which makes it easier to open these feeds in another feed reader.

7.2.2 Feed Readers

We shall discuss a few feed readers next.

7.2.2.1 FeedDemon

This comes across as a thoughtfully, well put together feed reader. After installation, you have the option to load the preinstalled feed lists. If needed, a user can subscribe to a new feed by using the Subscribed button. After entering the XML address, you have the option to preview a feed before continuing with the subscription. During the installation, you are presented with a form to sign up at Newsgator.com for free. As a member of the site, you can also search for feeds on any site by just entering the Web site address. In practice, though, this didn't seem functional.

The layout of the panes can be changed under the View menu. FD allows messages to be categorised by flagging them or moving them to the Clippings



The FeedDemon interface